

HIGHER SECONDARY SECOND YEAR (H.S. 2nd Year)
POLITICAL SCIENCE – 2022 (Code: 32T POSC)

Solved Question Paper (Guide)

Full Marks: 100 | Time: 3 Hours

Note: As this is a guide, all questions are solved, including every 'OR' / 'Any ____' question.

PART – A : Contemporary World Politics

Q.1 (1 mark each)

Q.1(a) Write the full form of NIEO.

Ans:

New International Economic Order.

Q.1(b) The collapse of which country is known as the collapse of the 'Second World'?

Ans:

The Soviet Union (USSR).

Q.1(c) In which year Iraq invaded Kuwait?

Ans:

1990.

Q.1(d) Write the full form of SAFTA.

Ans:

South Asian Free Trade Area.

Q.1(e) Earth Summit was held in the year _____.

Ans:

1992 (at Rio de Janeiro, Brazil).

Q.1(f) The World Council of Indigenous People was formed in 1974/1975/1976.

Ans:

1975.

Q.2 – 7 (2 marks each)

Q.2 Mention two reforms Mikhail Gorbachev initiated in the Soviet Union.

Ans:

Mikhail Gorbachev (leader from 1985) introduced two reforms in the Soviet Union:

- Perestroika: economic restructuring, giving freedom to enterprises and reducing central control.
- Glasnost: openness, i.e., freedom of speech, press and political liberalisation.

Q.3 Write down the names of the Permanent member states of Security Council of UNO.

Ans:

The five Permanent Members of the Security Council are the USA, Russia (earlier USSR), the United Kingdom, France and China. They have the power of veto.

Q.4 Write the names of two NGOs concerned with Protection of Human Rights all over the world.

Ans:

- Amnesty International
- Human Rights Watch

Q.5 Name the principal organs of the United Nations Organisation.

Ans:

The six principal organs of the UNO are:

- General Assembly
- Security Council
- Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC)
- Trusteeship Council
- International Court of Justice (ICJ)
- Secretariat

Q.6 Mention two sources of threats to human being.

Ans:

Two sources of threat to human beings are:

- Violence: war, terrorism, civil wars and genocide.
- Hunger, poverty, epidemics/diseases and environmental problems like global warming.

Q.7 Write two causes of Water Pollution.

Ans:

- Discharge of untreated industrial waste and sewage into rivers and lakes.
- Use of chemical fertilisers and pesticides, dumping of plastic and garbage, and oil spills.

Q.8 – 12 (4 marks each)

Q.8 Why did big powers need to have alliance with smaller countries? Write four reasons.

Ans:

Big powers need alliances with small countries because:

- Resources: small countries supply oil, minerals and raw materials.
- Territory/bases: they provide locations to station troops, weapons and to spy on rivals.
- Economic support: small allies help meet military expenses and offer markets and investment.
- Ideological/political support: alliances give legitimacy and votes in the UN, and strengthen the bloc against the opposite camp.

Q.9 Discuss briefly about the constraints on U.S. hegemony.

Ans:

The US is the world's sole superpower but its dominance has limits:

- Institutional architecture: the American political system (separation of powers, Congress, courts) restrains the use of power by the executive.
- Open nature of American society: public opinion and the media can oppose wars (e.g., the Vietnam war, Iraq war).
- Alliances such as NATO: the allies' wishes and the only 'organisation' that may check the US; cooperation of the members is needed.

- Rise of other powers (China, Russia, EU, India) and costs of wars, debt and terrorism also limit it.

Q.10 Discuss briefly about the recent relationship between India and Pakistan.

Ans:

India and Pakistan became independent in 1947. Recent relations have been mixed:

- Kashmir dispute, cross-border terrorism (Parliament attack 2001, Mumbai 26/11 in 2008, Pulwama 2019) and surgical strikes (2016, 2019 Balakot) increased tension.
- Peace efforts: Lahore bus service (1999), Agra Summit (2001), composite dialogue, trade and people-to-people contacts, ceasefire agreements.
- Abrogation of Article 370 in 2019 further worsened relations; Pakistan reduced diplomatic and trade ties.
- Both are nuclear powers, so peace between them is important for South Asia.

Q.11 Write briefly about Global Poverty.

Ans:

Global poverty is the condition in which a large number of people in the world lack basic needs like food, shelter, health and education. About 700 million people live in extreme poverty (below \$2.15 per day).

- It is mostly found in South Asia and Sub-Saharan Africa; in the developing world, poverty is linked with unemployment, illiteracy and inequality.
- Causes: unequal world economy, population growth, debt, wars and climate change.
- The UN's Millennium Development Goals and Sustainable Development Goals (SDG 1: no poverty) aim to end it.

Global poverty is also a threat to human security.

Q.12 Discuss briefly about the Political Consequences of Globalization.

Ans:

Political consequences of globalisation:

- The power and sovereignty of the state have weakened as international bodies (WTO, IMF, UN) and MNCs influence policy.
- The role of the state has changed from welfare to minimal ('night-watchman') state, though the state remains important in law and order and security.
- Rise of non-state actors like NGOs, MNCs and international organisations in decision-making.
- Possibility of cooperation among states and spread of democratic ideas, but also fears of dominance by powerful nations.

Q.13 – 14 (6 marks each)

Q.13 Why did Soviet Union disintegrate? Discuss three reasons.

Ans:

The Soviet Union disintegrated in December 1991 for these three main reasons:

- Economic weakness: the planned economy was stagnant and inefficient; there were shortages of consumer goods, and huge military spending (the arms race with the USA and the Afghan war) drained resources. Most people were dissatisfied.
- Political and administrative weakness: the Communist Party was authoritarian, corrupt and bureaucratic, and it lost the people's trust; there was no freedom of speech or democracy.

- Rise of nationalism and Gorbachev's reforms: the republics (Baltic states, Ukraine, Georgia) demanded independence; Gorbachev's Glasnost and Perestroika increased criticism of the system and weakened central control; the failed coup of August 1991 and Boris Yeltsin's leadership led to the final break-up.

Thus the USSR broke into 15 independent states and the Cold War ended.

[OR] Q.13 Discuss elaborately the U.S. hegemony as an Economic Super Power.

Ans:

The USA is the world's greatest economic superpower:

- Its economy is the largest in the world, accounting for about a quarter of world GDP; the dollar is the main reserve currency and used in most trade.
- After the Second World War it created the Bretton Woods system: the IMF, World Bank and later GATT/WTO, which it controls through its voting power; and the Marshall Plan rebuilt Europe.
- Its MNCs (Apple, Microsoft, Google, Amazon, Coca-Cola) and technology and universities dominate the world.
- It can use sanctions and the dollar financial system as tools of power.
- Challenges to this hegemony: China's rise, the 2008 financial crisis, huge debt and the move toward 'de-dollarisation'.

Q.14 What are the main pillars of ASEAN? Discuss elaborately.

Ans:

ASEAN (Association of Southeast Asian Nations) was established on 8 August 1967 by the Bangkok Declaration with five members (Indonesia, Malaysia, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand); now it has ten members. Its motto is 'One Vision, One Identity, One Community'. Its Secretariat is at Jakarta. Its three pillars are:

1. ASEAN Security Community (ASC):

It aims at peaceful settlement of disputes and regional peace; the ASEAN Regional Forum (1994) and the Treaty of Amity and Cooperation (1976) work for this; non-interference is a basic principle.

2. ASEAN Economic Community (AEC):

It aims at a single market and production base, free flow of goods, services and investment, and reducing the development gap; the ASEAN Free Trade Area (AFTA) is part of it, along with trade pacts with India, China and others.

3. ASEAN Socio-Cultural Community (ASCC):

It aims at cooperation in education, culture, health, environment and social development, to create a common ASEAN identity.

[OR] Q.14 Discuss India's relationship with China.

Ans:

India–China relations:

- Beginning: India recognised the People's Republic of China (1950); the Panchsheel agreement was signed in 1954 ('Hindi-Chini bhai bhai').
- Conflict: the Tibet issue and boundary dispute led to the 1962 war; China occupied Aksai Chin. Later clashes occurred at Nathu La (1967), Doklam (2017) and Galwan (2020).
- Normalisation: ambassadors were exchanged again in 1976, and Rajiv Gandhi visited China in 1988; agreements for peace on the border (1993, 1996) followed.
- Economic ties: China has become a large trading partner of India, though India has a big trade deficit.

- Irritants: China's friendship with Pakistan (CPEC), objection to India's membership of NSG/UNSC, Brahmaputra dams, and the Dalai Lama.

India follows a policy of dialogue and cautious cooperation with China.

PART – B : Politics in India Since Independence

Q.15 (1 mark each)

Q.15(a) In which year first general election was held in India?

Ans:

1951–52.

Q.15(b) Who was the first Chief Election Commissioner of India?

Ans:

Sukumar Sen.

Q.15(c) Write the full form of NEFA.

Ans:

North East Frontier Agency (now Arunachal Pradesh).

Q.15(d) Panchsheel principles were jointly declared by Indian Prime Minister _____ and Chinese Premier Zhou Enlai.

Ans:

Jawaharlal Nehru (1954).

Q.15(e) Who started 'Total Revolution'?

Ans:

Jayaprakash Narayan (J.P.), in 1974.

Q.15(f) What is the full form of MNF?

Ans:

Mizo National Front.

Q.16 – 21 (2 marks each)

Q.16 When was the Bharatiya Jana Sangh formed? Who was the founder President of Jana Sangh?

Ans:

The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was formed in 1951; its founder President was Syama Prasad Mukherjee.

Q.17 Write the names and symbols of any two National Political Parties in India.

Ans:

- Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP): Lotus
- Indian National Congress (INC): Hand (palm)

Q.18 Write two consequences of 1977 Lok Sabha Election.

Ans:

- Defeat of the Congress for the first time at the Centre and formation of the Janata Party government under Morarji Desai (the first non-Congress government).
- End of the Emergency: restoration of civil liberties, press freedom and democracy; Congress lost badly in North India.

Q.19 Write any two features of Coalition Government in India.

Ans:

- Governments are formed by two or more parties, so no single party has a majority of its own.
- Decisions are taken after consultation, and regional parties get a bargaining role; stability depends on a common minimum programme.

Q.20 Write two causes of the emergence of communalism in India.

Ans:

- The divide and rule policy of the British and the Partition of India in 1947.
- Use of religion for political gain (vote-bank politics), along with poverty, unemployment and illiteracy.

Q.21 Write two causes of origin of regionalism in India.

Ans:

- Differences of language, culture, religion and tribe among regions.
- Regional economic imbalance and neglect of some regions by the Centre.

Q.22 – 26 (4 marks each)

Q.22 Explain briefly about 'Two-Nation Theory'.

Ans:

The Two-Nation Theory said that Hindus and Muslims are two separate nations with different religions, culture and ways of life, and so cannot live together in one state.

- It was first stated by Sir Syed Ahmad Khan and the poet Iqbal, and promoted by Muhammad Ali Jinnah and the Muslim League; the Lahore Resolution (1940) demanded a separate state for Muslims.
- Congress, led by Gandhi and Nehru, opposed it and believed in a united secular India.
- The British policy of divide and rule helped it, and it led to the Partition in 1947 and the creation of Pakistan; its fault was shown by the 1971 creation of Bangladesh, as language proved stronger than religion.

Q.23 Why did India adopt the Policy of Non-Alignment? Discuss briefly.

Ans:

India adopted non-alignment because:

- To keep independence in foreign policy and take decisions on merit, not under pressure of any bloc.
- To concentrate on economic development and avoid military alliance expenses.
- To protect the newly won freedom and to keep India's neutrality in the Cold War, as both blocs were helpful for aid and technology.
- India's diversity and security concerns, and the desire of Nehru to lead the Afro-Asian world with Tito and Nasser (NAM 1961).

Q.24 Discuss briefly the causes of decline of the Congress Party.

Ans:

Causes of the decline of the Congress Party:

- Death of strong leaders (Nehru, Shastri) and later the weakening of organisation and loss of inner-party democracy due to the centralisation and personalisation of power (Indira Gandhi).
- Emergence of strong regional parties and the rise of caste and religion-based politics (Mandal, Mandir).

- The 1969 split and the Emergency (1975–77) reduced its image, and corruption scandals (Bofors) damaged it.
- Failure to adjust to the new social groups (OBCs, Dalits), and the rise of the BJP; coalition politics began after 1989.

Q.25 Discuss briefly the importance of Social Movement.

Ans:

Social movements are collective efforts of people to bring change in society (e.g., Chipko, Narmada Bachao Andolan, Dalit Panthers, women's and Bhartiya Kisan Union movements). Their importance:

- They give voice to the marginalised and raise issues ignored by parties and the government.
- They strengthen democracy by creating awareness and keeping the government accountable; they act as a check against the abuse of power.
- They bring policy change and new laws (e.g., Right to Information Act, 2005, which grew from the MKSS movement).
- They protect the environment and the rights of women, tribals and farmers, and promote participation of people.

Q.26 Explain any two reasons for the emergence of the Coalition Politics in the Indian Democratic System.

Ans:

Two main reasons for the emergence of coalition politics:

- Decline of Congress dominance: after 1967 and especially 1989, no single party could win a clear majority in the Lok Sabha, so parties had to join together to form the government.
- Rise of regional parties and identity-based politics (caste, religion, region, language): these parties became strong in their states and necessary allies at the Centre.

The multi-party system and the FPTP electoral system also helped.

Q.27 – 28 (6 marks each)

Q.27 Discuss the main controversies around planned development in the early years of India's Independence.

Ans:

After independence India adopted planning (Planning Commission 1950, First Plan 1951). Controversies about planned development were:

- Agriculture vs industry: the First Plan stressed agriculture, but the Second Plan (Mahalanobis model, 1956) gave priority to heavy industry; critics said agriculture was neglected.
- Public vs private sector: Nehru favoured a mixed economy with a strong public sector; industrialists (Bombay Plan) and the Swatantra Party wanted more private enterprise.
- Large vs small industries: Gandhians wanted village and cottage industries while others wanted large industries for rapid growth.
- Centralisation vs states' rights: states complained that the Centre dominated planning.
- Land reforms and inequality: benefits of planning did not reach the poor, and foreign aid dependence was also debated.

Despite this, planning laid the base of India's industrial development.

[OR] Q.27 What do you mean by planned development? Discuss the role of Planning Commission in the development of India.

Ans:

Planning means deciding in advance the goals, resources and methods for achieving economic and social development within a fixed period. In India the Planning Commission was set up in 1950 (replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015) and the Five Year Plans were followed.

Role of the Planning Commission in development:

- It prepared the Five Year Plans and decided priorities for agriculture, industry, power, irrigation and transport.
- It made proper use of limited resources and promoted growth (Green Revolution, steel plants, big dams such as Bhakra-Nangal).
- It worked to remove poverty and unemployment and reduce regional and income inequalities.
- It aimed at self-reliance, social welfare (education and health) and balanced regional development.

Thus planning played an important role, though not all its aims were fully achieved.

Q.28 Discuss the consequences of National Emergency declared on 25th June, 1975.

Ans:

The Emergency was declared on 25 June 1975 by Indira Gandhi under Article 352 on the ground of 'internal disturbance'. Its consequences were:

- Fundamental rights were suspended, press censorship was imposed, and thousands of opposition leaders (J.P. Narayan, Morarji Desai, etc.) were arrested under MISA.
- Parliament extended its term and passed the 42nd Amendment (1976) giving more powers to the Centre; elections were postponed.
- Forced sterilisation and slum clearance (Sanjay Gandhi's Five-Point Programme) caused public anger.
- In the 1977 election the Congress was defeated and the Janata Party came to power, the 44th Amendment (1978) made it difficult to misuse emergency powers.
- Lessons: democracy is strong in India and cannot be ignored; the judiciary and press gained importance.

[OR] Q.28 Discuss elaborately about the Secessionist Movements of North-East India.

Ans:

Secessionist movements in North-East India demanded separation from India or great autonomy:

- Nagaland: The Naga National Council under A.Z. Phizo demanded independence from 1950s; armed rebellion followed; Nagaland became a state in 1963; the NSCN continues the demand for 'Greater Nagalim'.
- Mizoram: The Mizo National Front (MNF) led by Laldenga started a revolt in 1966 after the 1959 famine; the Mizoram Accord (1986) ended it and Mizoram became a state in 1987.
- Assam: the Assam Movement (1979–85) against illegal immigrants ended with the Assam Accord (1985); the ULFA demanded a sovereign Assam, and later Bodo, Karbi and other groups demanded separate states/autonomy.
- Manipur, Tripura and Meghalaya also saw insurgency by groups like the PLA and NLFT, and these were met by the government through the use of force (AFSPA), peace talks and creation of new states and autonomous councils.

The government's policy has been a mix of dialogue, accords, development and security measures.